TEACHER ONLY · QUIZ ANSWER KEY AND MARKING GUIDE

Past Simple vs. Past Progressive

PART A · EASIEST	PART B	PART C	PART D · HARDEST
40 points · 10 × 4	30 points · 10 × 3	20 points · 5 × 4	10 points · 4 + 6

All or nothing per item in Parts A and B. Spelling slips in an otherwise correct form (e.g. "stoped") lose 1 point, not the whole item.

A Choose the correct form

40 points · 4 each

#	Answer	What it tests
1	**was watching**	Action in progress at a specific past moment (the Hebrew-interference classic)
2	**went**	Finished action in a finished time period
3	**were**	Agreement: *they were*
4	**see**	Base form after *didn't*
5	**was cooking**	*while* + the long action
6	**finish**	Base form after *did* in questions
7	**knew**	Stative verb: no -ing
8	**turned**	A sequence of completed actions
9	**were talking**	Already in progress when she came in ("nobody heard her")
10	**when**	*when* + the short interrupting action

B Complete the story

30 points · 3 each

#	Answer	Why
1	**went**	Finished event
2	**arrived**	Short action
3	**was raining**	Background
4	**decided**	Completed decision
5	**were sitting**	*while* + long action

#	Answer	Why
6	**started**	Event in the sequence
7	**shouted**	Short, sudden action
8	**was crossing**	In progress at that moment
9	**didn't have**	*have* (= own) is stative
10	**took**	Irregular, completed action

Also accept: 8 *were crossing* (a family = a group; both are used). 9 *did not have*. **Don't accept:** 3 *rained*, 9 *wasn't having*, 10 *taked*.

C Find and fix the mistake

20 points · 4 each

4 points for a fully correct sentence. 2 points if the student found the mistake but the fix is still wrong. For item 4, 4 points for a tick and 0 for any "correction".

#	Correct sentence	Why
1	When I **arrived** at school, the bell was ringing.	*was* + base form doesn't exist
2	Where **were you** going at 8 o'clock last night?	Questions need inversion
3	While we were playing football, it **started** to rain.	The rain starting is the short, interrupting action
4	✓ **Correct as it is**	*have* = eat is an action, so *was having dinner* is fine. Only *have* = own is stative.
5	She **wanted** a new phone for her birthday.	*want* is stative

D Write it yourself

10 points

D1 · 2 × 2 points

1. **My brother was sleeping when the fire alarm went off.**
   or: The fire alarm went off while my brother was sleeping.
2. **While I was doing my homework, my parents were watching the news.**
   Both verbs progressive: two long actions at the same time. "When I was doing…, my parents were watching…" is acceptable.

2 points: both tenses right. 1 point: one verb wrong, or a form error (e.g. "was go off"). 0: both wrong.

D2 · 6 points

Criterion	Points
At least one correct Past Progressive describing the scene	2
At least one correct Past Simple for something that happened	2
when or *while* used correctly	1
Three sentences, no form errors (*was* + base form, *did* + past, agreement)	1

Model answer: At 7:30 my mum was making coffee and my sister was looking for her shoes. My dad was reading the news on his phone. While I was eating breakfast, the cat jumped on the table and knocked over my juice.

READING THE RESULTS

Low marks in **A and B** mean the student still mixes up the forms: re-teach with the timeline and the colour-coded story. A good A–B with a weak **C** usually means questions and stative verbs need another round. Part D separates students who can use the tenses from those who can only recognise them.